

success, securing more than 200 performances in the first year alone and inspiring Beethoven's opera *Fidelio* (1805).

Following the storming of Paris's Tuileries Palace in August 1792, Cherubini moved to Rouen. On his return to the French capital in 1794, he married Anne-Cécile Tourette; the couple had three children. Three years later, he produced *Médée*, or *Medea*, his most famous work, and in 1800 another immense success, *Les Deux Journées* (1800)—based on an event during the so-called Reign of Terror, when revolutionaries took over the government—which was popular throughout the 19th century.

In 1806, after a year-long stay in Vienna for work, Cherubini fell into a deep depression and, turning away from composition, developed an interest in botany and painting. He resumed writing in 1808, but from 1816 composed mainly religious music, notably *Requiem in C minor* (1816)—praised by other musicians and played at Beethoven's funeral—and *Requiem in D minor* (1836).

In 1822, Cherubini became director of the Paris Conservatoire. He wrote his book *Cours de contrepoint et de fugue* in 1835. The composer died in Paris in 1842, aged 81, and was buried in Père Lachaise cemetery.